

TABLE 2-1
PRICES PAID BY MILLIONAIRES FOR CLOTHING AND
ACCESSORIES

SUIT OF CLOTHING			PAIR OF SHOES			WRISTWATCH		
Most Ever Spent	% That Paid This Amount or:		Most Ever Spent	% That Paid This Amount or:		Most Ever Spent	% That Paid This Amount or:	
	Less	More		Less	More		Less	More
\$195	10	90	\$73	10	90	\$47	10	90
\$285	25	75	\$99	25	75	\$100	25	75
\$399	50	50	\$140	50	50	\$235	50	50
\$599	75	25	\$199	75	25	\$1125	75	25
\$999	90	10	\$298	90	10	\$3800	90	10
\$1400	95	5	\$334	95	5	\$5300	95	5
\$2800	99	1	\$667	99	1	\$15000	99	1

These figures are for *all* millionaires in our survey. Keep in mind that almost 14 percent of those surveyed told us they inherited their wealth. What happens when we break out inheritors and self-made millionaires? Self-made millionaires spend significantly less for suits, as well as for most other high-status items, than do those who have inherited their wealth. The typical (50th percentile) self-made millionaire paid about \$360 for a suit, while the typical inheritor of wealth reported paying more than \$600.

How can the Johnnys of America get away with spending such modest amounts? Johnny does not need to wear expensive suits. He is not a successful attorney who must impress his clients. Nor does he ever have to impress a large audience of stockholders at an annual meeting, the financial press, or investment bankers. Johnny does not have to dress the part of a high-powered CEO who must constantly address a high-brow board of directors. Johnny does, however, need to impress his staff of janitors. How? By never giving them the impression that he is making so much money he can afford to have a tailor fit him for a suit priced in the low-to mid-four figures.

Most of the millionaires we have interviewed over the past twenty years have views similar to Johnny's. Then who purchases all those expensive suits? Our survey has revealed an interesting relationship. For every millionaire who owns a \$1,000 suit, there are at least six owners